

Agile Values Trade-off Scenarios

Day 1 · Activity 3 handout. Four real trade-offs. For each, name the Agile Manifesto value at play, what it implies, what it does *not* imply — then decide what your triad would do.

The Manifesto (your decision frame)

Individuals and interactions over processes and tools **Working software** over comprehensive documentation **Customer collaboration** over contract negotiation **Responding to change** over following a plan

That is, while there is value in the items on the right, we value the items on the left more. The Manifesto is a **prioritization aid for trade-offs**, not a checklist — and it never says "no docs," "no plan," or "no process."

The scenarios

Scenario 1 — from Week 5

"Should we hand-write a longer technical spec or get to coding faster?"

- **Manifesto frame:** Working software over comprehensive documentation.
- **But:** a TPM still ships a PRD / TCD / TMD / SEP. The Manifesto doesn't say "no docs."
- **Discuss:** when does documentation become a *substitute* for working software?

Scenario 2 — from Week 6

"A senior stakeholder asked for a contract change to your scope mid-sprint."

- **Manifesto frame:** Customer collaboration over contract negotiation.
- **But:** contracts (including PRDs, sign-offs) are how teams stay aligned.
- **Discuss:** when is the contract serving alignment vs. blocking it?

Scenario 3 — new

"Mid-quarter, customer behavior data shifts and your top user pain moves to a different friction. Do you keep building what's planned, or pivot?"

- **Manifesto frame:** Responding to change over following a plan.
- **Discuss:** how do you pivot without thrashing the team?

Scenario 4 — from Week 7 setup

"An engineer wants to skip the standup, but the standup is 'the agile way.'"

- **Manifesto frame:** Individuals and interactions over processes and tools.
- **Standups are a tool, not a value.**

- **Discuss:** when is the ceremony serving collaboration vs. replacing it?
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Triad protocol

1. **For each scenario** (8 min each):
 - State the Manifesto value at play.
 - State what the value implies.
 - State what the value does *not* imply.
 - Decide: what would your triad do?
2. **Final synthesis** (8 min): which Manifesto value did your triad invoke most? Least? Why?

What "good" looks like

- Each Manifesto value is named **with its non-implication** ("doesn't mean no docs / no plan / no process").
- Your decision is grounded in evidence (data, customer signal, team capacity) — not "the Manifesto says so."